SEMESTER 1 2026-27

University of Southampton Business School

INDIVIDUAL COURSEWORK BRIEF:

Module Code:	MANG3054	**Assessment:**	Report	**Weighting:**	100%
Module Title:	Marketing in the Digital Age				
Module Leader:	Dr Carmen Lopez				
Submission Due Date: @ 16:00 UK Time		7th January 2027		**Word Count:**	3,000 words
Method of Submission:	Electronic via Blackboard or eAssignments Turnitin ONLY (Please ensure that your name does not appear on any part of your work)				

Any submissions after 16:00 on the deadline date will be subject to the standard University late penalties (see below), unless an extension has been granted.

Days Late:	**Mark:**
1	(final agreed mark) * 0.9
2	(final agreed mark) * 0.8
3	(final agreed mark) * 0.7
4	(final agreed mark) * 0.6
5	(final agreed mark) * 0.5
More than 5	**0**

This assessment relates to the following module learning outcomes:

A. Knowledge and understanding	• The role of technology in providing insight into customer relationships, behaviour and decision-making; • Ethical questions raised by these technologies, the concepts of social responsibility and sustainability; • The criticality of the value proposition and the role of marketing in its communication and delivery; • The cumulative contribution of digital age marketing gurus to current practice. • The importance of digital technologies in establishing, evaluating and improving customer satisfaction; • The challenges and opportunities for traditional marketing in digital age organisations and markets;
B. Subject Specific Intellectual and Research Skills	• Understand courses of action based on a 'rational' and 'irrational' consumer behaviour profiles; • Evaluate conventional, digital and alternative marketing strategies; • Evaluate and apply digital age marketing principles and techniques; • Formulate campaigns and strategies based on digital age perspectives;
C. Transferable and Generic Skills	• Critically analyse and evaluate marketing concepts; • Demonstrate effective oral and or written communications.

Coursework Brief:

This coursework enables you to combine the research and analysis you have completed to produce an individual assignment for a British brand, **Popcorn Kitchen** (https://popcornkitchen.co.uk/). You will focus on Popcorn Kitchen's digital marketing strategies in the UK, concentrating solely on the consumer market.

Your role is to act as a marketing consultant hired by the company to analyse the market and Popcorn Kitchen's strategies for engaging with customers. You then need to advise them on how they could improve **customer engagement**.

For this piece of coursework, you are asked to:

a) Develop a brief overview of the brand and the relevant UK industry.
b) Identify the opportunities and threats for Popcorn Kitchen in the digital age.
c) Identify a specific segment to target and create a visual of the persona profile for Popcorn Kitchen in the UK.
d) Conceptualise customer engagement. Then, considering the customer persona, evaluate the capacity for customer engagement found in the digital marketing strategies (e.g., content development strategy, customer interaction strategy, customer experience strategy, social media strategies, etc.) used by Popcorn Kitchen.
e) Recommend improvements to Popcorn Kitchen's digital marketing strategy to enhance customer engagement.

Structure for the assignment:

Title page

Introduction

A brief introduction to Popcorn Kitchen and the relevant UK industry.

(Roughly 300 words)

Digital challenges and opportunities

Overview of two key challenges and two key opportunities that Popcorn Kitchen faces in the digital age.

(Roughly 400 words)

Target market & Customer persona profile

Identify and justify the segment to target (e.g., demographics, behaviours, attitudes, motivations, brands, etc.). Based on this segment, create a persona profile (visual format) for Popcorn Kitchen in the UK. The persona profile should reflect an existing segment and be based on research. Justify your choices.

(Roughly 500 words)

Customer engagement: Conceptualisation and evaluation of strategies

Define customer engagement and its dimensions. Considering the customer persona, evaluate Popcorn Kitchen's digital marketing strategies (e.g., content development strategy, customer experience strategy, social media strategies, etc.) used in the UK to engage with customers in light of the digital customer literature. Practical observations and examples of Popcorn Kitchen's customer engagement should be used to justify the arguments.

(Roughly 1200 words)

Recommendations

Considering the existing literature/theories, and the customer engagement strategies discussed in the previous section, suggest recommendations for the business to enhance customer engagement. Recommendations should be realistic and suitable for implementation over the next 6-12 months and should reflect informed judgement rather than a descriptive list of digital tools or tactics. Be creative and justify your recommendations.

(Roughly 600 words)

References

Appendix

Appendices are optional and should include only supplementary and concise material that supports the main analysis. Do not use appendices as an alternative location for core content that should appear in the main body of the report. Evidence/observations for the analysis of engagement strategies should be included in the main body.

* Please note the word count allocated to each section is a guideline only.

Marking/Grading Criteria:

Your work will be graded based on the following:

Introduction: 10%

Digital challenges and opportunities: 15%

Target market & Customer persona profile: 15%

Customer engagement: Conceptualisation and evaluation of strategies: 30%

Recommendations: 20%

Presentation, structure, writing style and referencing: 10%

Writing the report

- Title page: It should include the module code and name (MANG3054 Marketing in the Digital Age), assignment title (Digital Marketing assignment for Popcorn Kitchen), your student ID number and the word count (The word limit is 3000 +/- 10%).
- Structure your assignment: It is essential to have a strong and coherent structure. Use numbered headings to break your report into discrete sections. Adding subtitles (if appropriate) will make the report more structured and easier to read and comprehend.
- Avoid lengthy descriptions and lengthy paragraphs. Show that you can apply the digital marketing theories and concepts you have learned.
- The word count covers everything in the file (as per the word count function in the software package), including the title page but excluding the reference list and appendices.
- All tables and figures should be labelled and numbered. The source(s) of the table/figure needs to be cited.

- Follow the Harvard Referencing System. The reference list (i.e., NOT a bibliography of everything that you have read) should be sorted alphabetically by first author's surname: do not separate out different types of sources (books, journals, etc) into different lists. Do not number the list.
- Use an appropriate writing style. This means avoiding informalities like "haven't", "can't" and "isn't", and avoid slang unless you need to use it - in a quotation - to make a point. Do not use abbreviations such as "&" for "and". Avoid using the first person (I, we).
- The first time you use an acronym (e.g., NPD), put the acronym in parentheses after the full term (e.g., new product development (NPD)). After that, you can stick to using the acronym.

University of Southampton Business School Coursework Policy

1. **Nature of Assessment:** This is a SUMMATIVE ASSESSMENT. See 'Weighting' section above for the percentage that this assignment counts towards your final module mark.

2. **Word Limit:** +/-10% either side of the word count is deemed to be acceptable. Any text that exceeds an additional 10% will not attract any marks. The relevant word count *includes* items such as cover page, executive summary, title page, table of contents, tables, figures, in-text citations and section headings, if used. The relevant word count *excludes* your list of references and any appendices at the end of your coursework submission.

   You should always include the word count (from Microsoft Word, not Turnitin), at the end of your coursework submission, before your list of references.

3. **Title/Cover Page:** You must include a title/cover page that includes: your Student ID, Module Code, Assignment Title, Word Count. This assignment will be marked anonymously; please ensure that your name does not appear on any part of your assignment.

4. **References:** You should use the Harvard style to reference your assignment. The library provides guidance on how to reference in the Harvard style here .

5. **Submissions and Late Penalties:** The assignment MUST be submitted electronically via Turnitin, which is accessed via the individual module on Blackboard. Further guidance on submitting assignments is available on the Blackboard support pages.

   Please note that the submission deadline for the University of Southampton Business School is **16.00 UK time for all coursework-based assessments.**

   Further information on penalties for work submitted after the deadline can be found here. Remember to allow enough time prior to the submission deadline to ensure your submission is processed on time as **all** late coursework submissions are subject to the late penalty policy. We would recommend you allocate 30 minutes to upload your work and check the submission has been processed and is correct. Please make sure you submit to the correct assignment link.

   The last submission prior to the deadline will be treated as the final submission and will be the copy that is assessed by the marker. It is your responsibility to ensure that the version received by the deadline is the final version; resubmissions after the deadline will not be accepted under any circumstances.

   You can access your assignment dashboard at any time to download a copy of the submission receipt using the receipt icon. It is vital that you make a note of your **Submission ID (Digital Receipt Number)**. This is a unique receipt number and is proof of successful submission. You may be

required to provide this number at a later date. We recommend that you take a screenshot of this page or note the number down on a piece of paper.

If you have any problems during the submission process you should contact ServiceLine immediately by email at Serviceline@soton.ac.uk or by phone on +44 (0)23 8059 5656.

6. **Special Considerations:** If you believe that extenuating circumstances have adversely affected your academic performance, you may be eligible for Special Considerations. Information regarding the regulations governing Special Considerations can be accessed via the University Regulations, and the link to Special Considerations application form, can be found here.

7. **Extension Requests:** If you require additional time to complete your assessment due to circumstances beyond your control, you can request a deadline extension, (usually) no earlier than 4 weeks before your deadline. Supporting information is required for extension requests longer than 5 days. You can find more information, including a link to the extension request form, here.

8. **Academic Responsibility & Conduct:** Please note that you can access Academic Responsibility & Conduct Guidance for Students via the Quality Handbook: here. Please note that any suspected cases of Academic Responsibility & Conduct will be escalated to the Academic Responsibility & Conduct Officer.

   Over recent years, the most common reasons for a breach of the regulations governing Academic Responsibility & Conduct were:

Breach	How to avoid
Plagiarism – *using the work, words, or ideas of another without proper acknowledgement. This includes citing work that you haven't read.*	• Always cite your sources. • Only cite what you have read and used. • "Direct quotes must be in quotation marks" with a page number if applicable. • If you read about the work of another in a source, say 'cited in' and cite where you read it (see here for more info).
Collusion – *Collaborating with others in an unauthorized way to produce academic work meant to be done independently.*	• Unless permitted in a group assignment, don't work with/alongside others. • Don't share your work with others. • Ensure you are clear on where the line is. If in doubt, don't do it. •
External authorship – *Obtaining or attempting to obtain unauthorized input from another person or service for academic work, e.g GenAI*	• Ensure you are clear on if you are permitted to use GenAI. • Ensure your work is always your own. • Never send your work to others or upload it to a website. • Keep records of your work including notes, drafts, and reading.

Penalties for the above include mark reduction, resubmitting for a capped mark, or a '0' for the module.

If you are in any doubt, please ask.

Further learning and advice can be found in the Academic Responsibility & Conduct Toolkit, and the Library Website.

9. **Feedback:** The University of Southampton Business School is committed to providing feedback within 20 working days, where possible. Once marks are released and you have received your feedback, you can meet with your Module Leader / Module Lecturer / Personal Academic Tutor to discuss your feedback. Any additional arrangements for feedback may be listed in the Module Profile. Please note, all marks are considered provisional until ratified by the Board of Examiners.

10. **Student Support**: Study skills and language support for Southampton Business School students is available at: http://www.sbsaob.soton.ac.uk/study-skills-and-language-support/.